

ROBOTIC KITS

POPULARITY ON RISE

There is a high demand for programmable bots that can be interfaced to different motors and sensors

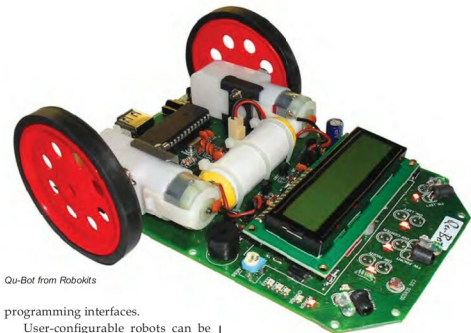
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The types of robotics kits available in India have grown rapidly in the last four to five years. The main consumers are students, mostly the engineering students, and hobbyists.

Robotic kits help you to understand the concepts behind the robots and robot building in a concise manner. These also let you program the robot using simple visual programming languages, helping you to have a structured thinking towards problem solving.

Many types of robotic kits are available, including toy kits, hobby kits and educational kits. In other words, all kinds of machines that are used to play with, experiment on and educate, consist of robotic kits. These may range from simple wheeled robots to complex robots such as humanoids, and from simple remote-controlled to PC-controlled robots.

Do-it-yourself (DIY) kits are targeted at those who want to learn how to construct a robot. These usually come with a small handbook explaining how to put together the spare parts provided in the box. On the other hand, preassembled kits are for those who want to learn to program a robot or use a robot for their own research applications. These come with hardware schematics to explain the circuits and good documentation for



Qu-Bot from Robokits

programming interfaces.

User-configurable robots can be classified into three different sectors, viz., consumer, industrial and toys. Toy robots are experiencing a boom. Easily reconfigurable toy robot kits are widely being used by youths for different competitions.

You should prefer those kits which give lots of features at low price and are easy to build and learn. Line-follower or remote-controlled robotic kits are not programmable and generally have a single function, but these are affordable. Also available are imported kits like LEGO, robonova humanoid, robotic arm and hexapods, which are really good but costly.

Robotic kits in India are offered by players like MacNet Technology, Energid Technologies, Rhydo Technologies, Kits'n'Spares (an EFY associate),

ThinkLABS, Techtronics Education, Robokits, Robosoft Systems, Gridbots Technologies and NEX Robotics.

Target groups

Main buyers of robotic kits in India are engineering students. Making these programmable mechanical devices helps them in understanding and conceptualising the theories involved. Outside India, the consumers are mostly hobbyists and researchers.

In terms of target groups, the robots are being offered for:

1. Children up to the age of 16 and their parents
2. Schools
3. Engineering students and hobbyists